BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

Install Node.js and OpenClaw

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MODULE 4 — DOWNLOAD PACKET

Step-by-Step Installation Guide

Before You Start

You will complete two installations:

1. **Node.js** — the engine OpenClaw runs on
2. **OpenClaw** — your AI CEO's operating platform

Both installations take about 5 to 10 minutes total. Follow each step in order.

PART 1 — Install Node.js

Node.js is a software runtime that allows OpenClaw to run on your computer. Think of it as the engine your AI CEO needs to operate — the same way a car needs an engine before it can drive.

Step 1 — Open Your Browser

Open any web browser (Safari, Chrome, Firefox — any of them work).

Step 2 — Go to the Node.js Website

In your browser address bar, type:

```
nodejs.org
```

Press Enter.

Step 3 — Download the LTS Version

On the Node.js homepage you will see two download buttons.

Choose the one labeled LTS.

> *LTS stands for Long Term Support. It is the stable, reliable version recommended for most users. Do not choose the "Current" version.*

Click the **LTS** button to download the installer.

Step 4 — Run the Installer

On a Mac:

1. Find the downloaded file — it ends in `.pkg`
2. Double-click it to open the installer
3. Click **Continue**
4. Click **Agree** to accept the license
5. Click **Install**
6. Enter your Mac password if prompted
7. Click **Close** when the installation is complete

On Windows:

1. Find the downloaded file — it ends in `.msi`
2. Double-click it to open the installer
3. Click **Next** through each screen
4. Accept the default settings
5. Click **Install**
6. Click **Finish** when complete

Step 5 — Open Terminal

On a Mac:

Press **Command + Space** to open Spotlight Search.

Type `Terminal` and press Enter.

On Windows:

Press the **Windows key**, type `cmd`, and press Enter to open Command Prompt.

Step 6 — Verify the Installation

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
node --version
```

✅ **What you should see:** A version number like `v20.x.x` or `v22.x.x`

If you see a version number, Node.js is installed correctly. Move on to Part 2.

> ***If you see an error instead:*** *Close Terminal, reopen it, and try the command again. If it still fails, restart your computer and try once more.*

PART 2 — Install OpenClaw

Now that Node.js is installed, you will install OpenClaw using a tool called **npm** (Node Package Manager). npm is like an app store for developer tools — it downloads and installs software with a single command.

Step 7 — Install OpenClaw

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
npm install -g openclaw
```

> *The `-g` flag means "install globally" — OpenClaw will be available anywhere on your computer, not just in one folder.*

You will see a stream of text as npm downloads and installs OpenClaw. **This is normal.** Wait for it to finish. It usually takes 1 to 2 minutes depending on your internet speed.

When it is done, your terminal prompt will return to normal (you will see a blinking cursor again).

Step 8 — Verify OpenClaw Is Installed

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
openclaw --version
```

✅ **What you should see:** A version number printed in the terminal

If you see a version number, OpenClaw is installed and ready.

Step 9 — Run the Setup Wizard

You are now ready to configure OpenClaw.

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
openclaw onboard --install-daemon
```

This launches the OpenClaw setup wizard, which will walk you through the configuration one step at a time.

> ***Next:*** *Use the* ***OpenClaw Terminal Setup Cheat Sheet*** *to answer every question the wizard asks — in the exact order they appear.*

Quick Reference

Step	What You Do	Command or Action
1	Open your browser	—
2	Go to Node.js website	`nodejs.org`
3	Download LTS version	Click the LTS button
4	Run the installer	Follow the wizard
5	Open Terminal	Command + Space → Terminal
6	Verify Node.js	`node --version`
7	Install OpenClaw	`npm install -g openclaw`
8	Verify OpenClaw	`openclaw --version`
9	Run setup wizard	`openclaw onboard --install-daemon`

Troubleshooting

"command not found" after typing `node --version`

Node.js did not install correctly. Close Terminal, reopen it, and try typing the command again. If it still fails, restart your computer and try once more. If the problem continues, re-download the installer from nodejs.org and run it again.

"command not found" after typing `openclaw --version`

Close Terminal, reopen it, and try again. If the error continues, run the install command again:

```
npm install -g openclaw
```

npm shows a permission error on Mac

Type this command instead and press Enter:

```
sudo npm install -g openclaw
```

You will be asked for your Mac password. Type it and press Enter. (The characters will not appear as you type — that is normal.)

The installer download is taking a long time

This is normal on slower connections. Leave it running and wait for it to complete.

For additional help, visit the OpenClaw documentation at docs.openclaw.ai